

HUGO HOUSE YEARLONG WRITE THE FIRST DRAFT OF YOUR NOVEL, 2026/2027 BOOK PROPOSAL

PAUL M. CRAY

GENRE:

Historiographic metafiction (the novel is metafictional in that it is about itself as a novel, and historiographic in that it is about the technoeconomic and sociocultural forces that drive history). Alternatively, though the novel contains both science fiction (low magic) and fantasy (high magic), it is a fabulation, defined by John Clute in *The Encyclopedia of Science Fiction* as ‘any story which challenges the two main assumptions of genre sf: that the world can be seen; and that it can be told.’

TITLE:

The Visibilities

LOGLINE:

The travails of one man, and his avatars scattered across the multiverse, in attempting to overcome his cosmic loneliness and awake from the nightmare of history.

COMP TITLES:

Henry Adams, ‘A Law of Acceleration’ and ‘The Rule of Phase Applied to History’
Kingsley Amis, *Lucky Jim*
Martin Amis, *Money*
Isaac Asimov, *Extraterrestrial Civilisations*
Margaret Atwood, *The Handmaid’s Tale*
Julian Barnes, *A History of the World in 10½ Chapters*
Jorge Luis Borges, *Labyrinths*
William Cooper, *Scenes from Provincial Life*
Len Deighton, *Bomber*
BBC, *Doctor Who*
A. S. Byatt, *Possession*
John Clute and David Langford (eds), *The Encyclopedia of Science Fiction*
John Clute and John Grant (eds), *The Encyclopedia of Fantasy*
Jonathan Coe, *What a Carve Up!* (US title: *The Winshaw Legacy: or, What a Carve Up!*)
Umberto Eco, *The Name of the Rose*
Richard P. Feynman, Robert B. Leighton and Matthew Sands, *The Feynman Lectures on Physics*
C.B.P. Finn, *Thermal Physics*
Ian Fleming, *From Russia, with Love*
Michael Frayn, *Sweet Dreams*
Alan Garner, *Red Shift*
Alasdair Gray, *Lanark: A Life in Four Books*
Garth Risk Hallberg, *City on Fire*
Douglas R. Hofstadter, *Gödel, Escher, Bach: An Eternal Golden Braid*
B.S. Johnson, *Travelling People*
Uwe Johnson, *Anniversaries*
James Joyce, *Ulysses*
Donald E. Knuth, *The T_EXbook*
Stanley Kubrick and Arthur C. Clarke, *2001: A Space Odyssey*
Ursula K. Le Guin, *A Wizard of Earthsea*
David Lodge, *How Far Can You Go?* (US title: *Souls and Bodies*)
Marc W. Miller, *Traveller: Science-Fiction Adventure in the Far Future*
David Mitchell, *Cloud Atlas*
Christopher Priest, *The Prestige*
Thomas Pynchon, *Gravity’s Rainbow*
Frank Richards, *Billy Bunter and the Greyfriars Pretender*
Olaf Stapledon, *Star Maker*
Laurence Sterne, *The Life and Opinions of Tristram Shandy, Gentleman*
Neal Stephenson, *Cryptonomicon*

Nicholas Tomalin and Ron Hall, *The Strange Last Voyage of Donald Crowhurst*
Jenny Turner, *London Review of Books* articles (<https://www.lrb.co.uk/contributors/jenny-turner>)
Vernor Vinge, *A Fire Upon the Deep*
Kurt Vonnegut Jr., *Slaughterhouse-Five, or The Children's Crusade: A Duty-Dance with Death*
David Foster Wallace, *Infinite Jest*
Evelyn Waugh, *Sword of Honour* trilogy
Wisden Cricketers' Almanack 1977, 114th edition

BACK COVER COPY:

The main text of *The Visibilities* is forced into a 366-element tensor that becomes so overloaded that inevitably it bursts out of its confines to infect the paratext of the novel, including its peritext. *The Visibilities* is both a grimoire and a teratography. The front cover is a representation of a region of the Heptabrot set procedurally generated with METAPOST. At the centre is the hexagonal 'fort' surrounded by a beautifully rich, colourful, whirling, roiling sevenfold structure. The hexagonal fort is in the centre of the cover, the AR (Atomic Razor) device physically impressed (blind blocked) into the board (of the hardback, like the AP device on old Academic Press books). The back cover is similar, but shows a region of the Octabrot set. Here there is an eightfold structure surrounding the central—for this Multibrot set—heptagonal 'fort'. Ideally, matters will be arranged so that the sevenfold and eightfold structures seamlessly meld into one another, but the realisation of that element of the book is left for the future. The front and spine will carry the name of the author and title (plus the publisher's device). There will be no text on the back cover. The book will be sold new shrink-wrapped so that the barcode will go on the disposable outer covering, so that it is not corrupted by any extraneous commercial clutter.